

Startup Licenses & Compliance Checklist

SAMPLE TEMPLATE | Requirements vary by country, state and industry

Done	Item	Issued by / Purpose	Notes
☐	Business registration / incorporation	Company registrar - creates legal entity	[Jurisdiction-specific]
☐	Tax registration	Tax authority - income tax / corporate tax ID	
☐	Sales tax / VAT / GST registration	Tax authority - if turnover threshold met	
☐	Business bank account	Bank - needs incorporation papers	
☐	Local trade / operating licence	Municipal body - to operate premises	
☐	Shops & establishment / employer registration	Labour authority - if hiring staff	
☐	Payroll, social security & provident fund	Statutory bodies - employee contributions	
☐	Trademark application	IP office - protect brand name & logo	
☐	Domain name & brand handles	Registrar - secure web identity	
☐	Data protection registration / DPO	Regulator - if processing personal data	
☐	Industry-specific licences	e.g. fintech, health, food, education	
☐	Open-source licence audit	Internal - verify dependency licences	
☐	Insurance (liability / cyber)	Insurer - risk cover	

Official licences and registration certificates are issued only by the relevant government authority. This checklist lists what to apply for; it is not a substitute for those certificates.